

Website voice sweep

Every public page read on the live site on 7 October 2026, line by line, against how you talk and against the brand. A plan for you to inspect. Nothing on the site has been changed.

34

changes I recommend

5

your call, either way is
defensible

41

pages read, about 25,000 words

The one decision to make first

What does "sound like me" mean on the website? Your voice authority (01A, 7 October) says the website is not Tom's first person: it is "we", with your story told in the third person, and the Brand OS warns against the company becoming "Tom as the product". So I have read "sound like me" as your way of talking (direct, plain, medium-length sentences, no tricks, no drama) inside "we". I have not put "I" anywhere. If you meant something else, tell me before anything changes.

If you only do five

1. Rewrite the VAT Intervention on Evidence (and its line on the home page). It calls a named client's business a mess.
2. The four paid landing pages: hyphens, the stacked fragments, and bring Devon and Cornwall into line with your 2 October corrections.
3. The Commercial Review card on Where to Start and the Product Guide: "where the next edge may be" means nothing to an owner.
4. About Us: turn "The reason we are here" from five one-liners into one paragraph.
5. Fix the three wrong facts: the quiz "cost" claim, the "8–15 questions" line and the "one question" line on Useful Thinking.

Read on 7 October 2026 from the live site (production inspection run 20261007T114225Z-voice-sweep), plus two pages outside the sitemap read from the code. Authorities read the same day from Drive: OO TOM VOICE – START HERE and 01A TOM VOICE – WORKER SPEC (both last reviewed 7 October), Professional Tom Voice Programme, OO ARRINGTON BRAND OPERATING SYSTEM (last reviewed 9 September), Arrington Voice rules.

1 How each line was judged

Every line was asked three questions, in this order.

1. **Is it true and does it keep the rules?** A fact the page cannot back up, first person outside Useful Thinking, a dash or hyphen, a banned word, anything that implies the owner's business is broken. These are marked **Fact** or **Brand rule**.
2. **Would Tom say it?** Your CORE voice rules: direct, plain, conversational, medium-length sentences, no groups of three for effect, no stacked fragments, no AI mannerisms. Marked **Style**.
3. **Does changing it help the brand?** The test from the Brand OS: does it make a serious owner more likely to trust us and get in touch? If a line already works, it stays, even if I could write it differently. Marked **Commercial** where the change is about winning the enquiry.

Change means I recommend it. **Your call** means either version is defensible and it comes down to taste. **Keep** lines are listed under each page so you can see they were read, not skipped.

Left alone on purpose: client reviews (they are speech, published as written), the fifteen Useful Thinking articles (your own approved first-person writing; there is no tested voice track for them yet, so the voice rules say they are published exactly as you approved them), the start-up page (frozen during the Ads test), prices and offer names, and the Privacy page.

2 What I found across the whole site

The site is in better shape than I expected. The newest pages (What We Do, the sale readiness page, the taxi page) already sound like you. The older and more salesy pages carry five habits that give away AI writing.

HABIT	EXAMPLE ON THE SITE	WHAT I PROPOSE
"No X. No Y. Just Z."	"No jargon. No generic advice. Just practical insight." "No presentations. No jargon. Just an honest discussion."	One sentence each. This is the most recognisable AI pattern there is.
Stacked one-liners	About Us, "The reason we are here": five lines in a row.	One paragraph. Your Brand OS copy standard bans it outright.
Lists of three or four abstract nouns	"better control, clearer structure, stronger margin, and a business that..."	Say the outcome once. Real lists of real things (the five start-up areas, the build inclusions) stay.
"It's not X, it's Y"	"It wasn't about consultancy. It was about having the stomach..." "within days, not years"	Cut where it is a slogan. Keep where it removes a real worry ("not billed afterwards", "not a valuation").
Padding words	"actually" about 20 times, "properly" about 15, "genuine" about 10 on the commercial pages.	Keep only where they carry meaning. Fixed in the lines listed, not by a blanket sweep.

Hyphens (your 30 September ruling that they read as dashes in this font): 30-minute (four landing pages), day-to-day (Where to Start, Owner Check), free-text (Owner Check, Commercial Gaps Review), CRM-style (Where to Start), seven-figure (sale readiness), counsellor-led (Evidence), on-page and one-hour (Website Build pages), fifteen-year (Useful Thinking index). "fixed-price" in the £999 description stays, by your decision today. I suggest these all go in one pass.

3 Every page: header and footer

all pages

The enquiry block at the foot of every page is the line most visitors read last.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- "Tell us where the pressure is showing." / "You do not need a polished brief or perfect set of accounts." / "We ask a few direct questions. If a commercial review would help, we will say so. If it would not, we will say that too." Plain, honest and fit before sale, which is exactly how Tom talks to an enquiry. Keep.

4 Home

/

The page most paid and organic visitors see first.

CHANGE FACT

NOW

A free five minute quiz that shows where the business still depends on you, and what that is costing. No email required to see your result.

PROPOSED

A free five minute quiz that shows where the business still depends on you. No email needed to see your result.

Why: The quiz result gives a dependency score and where the load sits. It does not put a cost on anything, so the line promises more than the quiz delivers.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

The work is better control, clearer structure, stronger margin, and a business that leans less on the owner being in the middle of everything.

PROPOSED

What you should end up with is a business that makes better money and does not need you in the middle of everything.

Why: The line above it already says structure and margin. A list of four abstract nouns is the AI habit the voice rules name; Tom would say the outcome in one breath.

CHANGE BRAND RULE

NOW

We walked into a business where the growth was real but the oversight was non-existent.

PROPOSED

We came into a business that was growing fast, where nobody had been keeping an eye on the VAT.

Why: Tristan is a real client who left a five star review. "Non-existent oversight" judges him; the Brand OS says owners deserve to be understood before they are judged. Same facts, without the verdict.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Tom Arrington has spent over 20 years inside real businesses across Devon and Cornwall, where the small decisions made every day shaped the numbers, the people, the customers and the pressure on the owner. That experience now helps owner run businesses see which calls matter most.

PROPOSED

Tom Arrington has spent over 20 years inside real businesses across Devon and Cornwall, where the small calls made every day decide the numbers and how much ends up on the owner's plate. That is what we bring: knowing which calls matter most.

Why: Keeps the approved proof line word for word. Cuts the list of four and says it the way Tom would across a table.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- Hero: "You've built something you're proud of. So why does everything still run through you?" This is the reaction the Brand OS asks for in seconds.
- Proof strip (two decades, Oxford Said, 5.0 on Google). Three real facts, not three for effect.
- "We find where the business is losing time and money, and deal with the cause."
- The Insolvent Turnaround block, approved by you on 15 September.

5 What We Do

/what-we-do

Already the closest page on the site to how Tom talks. One small fix.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Nobody sees everything in their own business. We don't pretend we would either.

PROPOSED

Nobody sees everything in their own business, and we don't claim we would see everything in yours.

Why: As written it is not clear what "we would" refers to. One sentence says it plainly.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- Opening: "You know your business better than anyone. That is exactly why parts of it are hard to see from where you are standing." This is the Brand OS collaboration standard in Tom's words.
- "Change one thing in a business and something else often moves." The operating philosophy, said simply.
- The four areas (The owner, The people, The numbers, And everything else) and both prices.
- "Six months on." and the new taxi and sale readiness links.

6 About Us

/about-us

Tom's story is told in the third person here, which the Brand OS requires. It reads well; the block underneath it does not.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Soon after, Tom and his wife Hannah started Arrington Consultancy. Helping owners strengthen the structure underneath the business, so the business does not need the owner for everything.

Why: The second sentence has no verb. Joined, it reads as one thought.

PROPOSED

Soon after, Tom and his wife Hannah started Arrington Consultancy, to help owners strengthen what sits underneath the business so it does not need them for everything.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

...to formalise what those twenty years had actually taught him.

Why: "Actually" adds nothing here. It appears about twenty times across the commercial pages.

PROPOSED

...to formalise what those twenty years had taught him.

CHANGE BRAND RULE

NOW

Hannah brings it back to something practical. Clear positioning, consistent messaging, and no gap between what the business says and what it does.

Why: A fragment list of three marketing terms. The Brand OS copy standard bans manufactured short fragments; the point is the last item, so lead with it.

PROPOSED

Hannah brings it back to something practical, so what the business says is clear and matches what it actually does.

CHANGE BRAND RULE

NOW

The reason we are here. / We started this because we learned these lessons by running businesses ourselves. / Early on, an outside perspective would have saved time, money, and a lot of pressure. / Most of the time goes into keeping things running. What moves the business forward gets less attention. / The perspective we needed is the one we now bring.

Why: Five stacked one-liners. The voice rules name "constant short sentence stacking" as an AI habit, and the Brand OS copy standard says the same. One paragraph, same content, reads like a person.

PROPOSED

The reason we are here. / We started this because we learned these lessons running businesses ourselves. Most of an owner's time goes on keeping things running, and the things that move the business forward get less attention. An outside view early on would have saved us time, money and a lot of pressure, and that is the view we now bring.

YOUR CALL

STYLE

NOW

You've seen how we work. If something in your business is creating more pressure than it should, tell us what is going on.

Why: On About Us the visitor has read about the people, not the work, so the opening clause does not fit.

PROPOSED

If something in your business is creating more pressure than it should, tell us what is going on.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- The opening story: "At 22 Tom sold his PlayStation, TV and bike, then borrowed the rest to buy a struggling taxi firm." Concrete and his. Keep exactly.
- "Those years taught him that small daily decisions make or break a company."
- "Learned in the real world, then qualified in the classroom."

7 The four city landing pages (paid traffic)

/business-consultant-devon, -cornwall, -exeter, -plymouth

These are where the Google Ads land, so they matter most commercially. Exeter and Plymouth carry your 2 October corrections; Devon and Cornwall do not yet. Changes here should be applied to all four together and the Google Ads worker told.

CHANGE

BRAND RULE

NOW

Book your 30-minute conversation (button), and "A 30-minute conversation" and "a straightforward 30-minute conversation" in the copy

Why: You ruled on 30 September that hyphens read as dashes in this font. The rest of the site already says "30 minute".

PROPOSED

Book your 30 minute conversation, and 30 minute everywhere on these pages

CHANGE

FACT

NOW

The advice we give comes from businesses we have actually run, rebuilt and successfully exited.

Why: "We" did not run them; Tom did. The proof is stronger when it is accurate, and the Brand OS wants operator proof stated plainly.

PROPOSED

The advice comes from businesses Tom has run, rebuilt and sold.

CHANGE

BRAND RULE

NOW

No presentations. No jargon. Just an honest discussion about where things stand.

Why: Three stacked fragments ending in "Just..." is one of the most recognisable AI patterns. Same promise, one sentence.

PROPOSED

No presentation and no jargon, just an honest talk about where things stand.

CHANGE

COMMERCIAL

NOW

Devon and Cornwall only: "the next step is the Commercial Review, £500." and "No obligation. No pressure."

Why: Your 2 October corrections were applied to Exeter and Plymouth only, because that is what was asked. The four pages now say the same thing two ways. Bring Devon and Cornwall into line.

PROPOSED

"the next step is the £500 Commercial Review." and "No obligation."

CHANGE

STYLE

NOW

If your business depends too heavily on you, a commercial review helps identify what is working, what is getting in the way and where the biggest improvements can be made.

Why: "Helps identify" is consultant language and the list of three pads it. Tom would say what you get.

PROPOSED

If too much of the business depends on you, a commercial review shows what is getting in the way and what to sort out first.

CHANGE

STYLE

NOW

The objective is simple: better commercial decisions, clearer structure and a business that relies less on the owner being involved in everything.

Why: "The objective is simple:" followed by a list of three is a stock AI construction. The last item is the whole point.

PROPOSED

The aim is a business that relies less on the owner being involved in everything.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- The hero ("Business consultant for owner run businesses in Devon") and its proof line.
- The compact Insolvent Turnaround case study.
- "Some clients prefer to meet in person. Others work with us remotely."
- The town lists for each area.

8 Evidence

The strongest page on the site and the one with the passage I would change first.

CHANGE BRAND RULE

NOW

The VAT Intervention: "Tristan had built a success, but the back office was a black hole. ... a hidden liability that was threatening to swallow the company's entire cash reserve. We didn't just find the error; we sat in the room, untangled eighteen months of forensic data... It wasn't about "consultancy". It was about having the stomach to fix the mess the owner was too busy to see."

PROPOSED

Tristan had built a successful business and, like most owners, was busy running it. The VAT had been handled incorrectly for over a year, and the liability building up behind it was big enough to take the company's entire cash reserve. / We sat in the room with the figures, worked through eighteen months of data and rebuilt the reconciliation from scratch. We corrected the filing, secured the position with HMRC and saved the business from a six figure cash flow collapse.

Why: The most off-brand passage on the site. "The mess the owner was too busy to see" says a named client failed, which the Brand OS rules out. "Black hole", "swallow" and "It wasn't about X. It was about Y" are agency drama. Every fact and the outcome are kept.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Abacus: the badge "A seven figure exit / Nearly twenty years after Tom bought the business at 22", then straight after it "A seven figure exit, nearly twenty years after Tom bought the business at 22 with every penny he had."

PROPOSED

Keep the sentence, drop the badge text that repeats it.

Why: The same fact twice in a row. The sentence is the better of the two because it has "every penny he had".

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Years later, Abacus and Falmouth Taxis sold properly, not because everything had always gone right, but because the business had been rebuilt after things had nearly gone wrong.

PROPOSED

Years later Abacus and Falmouth Taxis sold, not because everything had gone right but because it had been rebuilt after things nearly went wrong.

Why: "Properly" appears three times in this case study (the subtitle says "rebuilt properly", which is fine and should stay).

CHANGE STYLE**NOW**

Margin case: "Profit margins improved / With no extra appointments" then "Profit margins improved with no extra appointments." then "That is what structure does."

Why: Repeats itself, then ends on a slogan. The voice rules say conclusions are never a slogan. "More profit from the same workload, with revenue improving as well." is the better last line.

PROPOSED

Keep the badge; drop the repeated sentence and the closing slogan.

CHANGE BRAND RULE**NOW**

World Student Advisors: "a free, counsellor-led service"

Why: Hyphen, per your 30 September ruling.

PROPOSED

a free service run by counsellors

CHECKED AND KEPT

- "Built, very nearly lost, then rebuilt properly" and the Abacus story itself.
- "The business was not struggling. It was busy and losing money it had already earned." This is the Brand OS in one line.
- The four documents and their descriptions (document titles such as "90-Day Action Plan" are the names of real files and stay).
- Scott: "Explaining controlled AI to a business owner in a meeting rarely lands. So we built a whole company instead."
- All five reviews, exactly as written. A client quote is speech (Brand OS); Nick's "tailored" and his dash are his, not ours.

9 Where to Start and the offer pages

/where-to-start and the four offer pages

The pages people read just before they pay. The hub is the weakest writing on the site: it sounds like a brochure, not like Tom.

CHANGE COMMERCIAL**NOW**

Commercial Review card: "A clear commercial read on where the next edge may be. ... Useful when the business has become richer, sharper or more capable than the website, offer or day-to-day operation currently shows."

Why: "Where the next edge may be" means nothing to an owner, and the second sentence describes the website offer, not the review. Two lists of three and a hyphen. The same kicker line also appears on the Product Guide.

PROPOSED

An outside read on the business, written down. / We listen properly, then give you a written assessment, our recommendations and what to do first, within 4 business days. If you go on to either bigger option, the £500 comes off.

YOUR CALL

STYLE

NOW

Website Build card: "A fixed-price build for businesses that are ready for more than a template. The site can include enquiry flows, payments, API integrations, CRM-style tracking or an AI assistant trained around your business..."

PROPOSED

A website built from scratch, not from a template, and completely customisable. It can take enquiries and payments, connect to the systems you already use, or answer customers with an AI assistant set up around your business, where that saves time or wins the right work.

Why: "API integrations" and "CRM-style tracking" are jargon an owner has to translate. The first sentence uses your own words from the start-up page.

CHANGE

STYLE

NOW

Implementation card: "For businesses that have already built something worth protecting and now need the next stage made easier to run: clearer decisions, follow-up that matches the standard of the business, systems around what already works and less work sitting with the owner."

PROPOSED

The review goes deeper, then we stay involved while the changes are shaped and started, so less of the work sits with you.

Why: A list of four abstractions after a colon. The plain version says what actually happens.

CHANGE

COMMERCIAL

NOW

Review and Website card: "...AI support, integrations and a site that helps move the business forward within days, not years."

PROPOSED

We review the business first, then build the website around what it has become, so it explains what you do now and handles enquiries properly.

Why: "Within days, not years" is a contrast slogan and a promise no page backs up.

CHANGE

STYLE

NOW

Commercial Review page: "A genuine Commercial Review in its own right. Its value is the judgement and written direction, not the size of the package around it."

PROPOSED

A Commercial Review in its own right. What you are paying for is the judgement, and a written direction you can act on.

Why: Reads as defensive about the price. £500 is simply the price (your rule), so it does not need defending.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Commercial Review page: "produce a written report: assessment, recommendations, direction, and next steps."

Why: Four near-synonyms. The replacement is the line already live on the landing pages, so the site says it one way.

PROPOSED

produce a written report: what we found, what we would do about it and what to do first.

YOUR CALL STYLE

NOW

Commercial Review page: "We listen for as long as it genuinely takes to understand the position, whether thirty minutes or two hours."

Why: Drops "genuinely" and "the position". Close to your own "about 30 minutes (always more)".

PROPOSED

We listen for as long as it takes, whether that is thirty minutes or two hours.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Implementation page: "Substantially more time to follow the evidence and understand the detail behind the first conversation..."

Why: Opens on a fragment. One plain sentence.

PROPOSED

We spend a lot more time following the evidence, including time inside the business where it helps, and work the recommendations through with you in far more depth.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Review and Website page: "They have grown, changed direction, added services, changed systems, changed customers or become materially different." and "Together, the work gives the business a fresh commercial platform for its next stage."

Why: "Changed" three times, then consultant language. The plain version names the actual problem.

PROPOSED

They have grown, added services or changed direction, and the website still describes the business they used to be. (Drop the "fresh commercial platform" sentence.)

CHANGE COMMERCIAL

NOW

Websites and AI page: "If we built World Student Advisors for £999, imagine what we could build for your business."

Why: "Imagine what we could build" is a sales line, and the Brand OS says not salesy. Showing the example is stronger than asking them to imagine.

PROPOSED

World Student Advisors was built for £999. Have a look, then tell us what yours needs to do.

CHANGE STYLE

NOW

Websites and AI and the £999 page: "Not dropped into a template."

Why: A fragment. Your own words from 6 October say it better.

PROPOSED

Built from scratch, not from a template, and completely customisable.

YOUR CALL STYLE

NOW

Websites and AI: "The technology matters. Understanding the business matters more."

Why: Two clipped lines read as a slogan; one sentence reads as Tom.

PROPOSED

The technology matters, but understanding the business matters more.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- The 30 Minute Conversation card: "...whether there is a real piece of work worth doing. If there is not, we will say so." Fit before sale, in Tom's words.
- "Six months later we check in to see what actually changed. It is a phone call, included with the work, not another stage to book."
- The scope and credit lines, and "fixed-price" in the £999 description (your ruling: one is fine).
- "This is not a design agency selling a favourite style." This "not" earns its place: it is the positioning.

10 Owner Check and the free tools

/owner-check, quiz, Market Ready Test, Commercial Gaps Review, Product Guide

Mostly sound. Two facts are wrong and the opening is an AI pattern.

CHANGE BRAND RULE

NOW

Owner Check: "Sometimes it's difficult to see your own business clearly. These short checks help you step back, answer a few honest questions and understand where your biggest opportunities may be. No jargon. No generic advice. Just practical insight."

Why: "No X. No Y. Just Z." is the single most recognisable AI construction. Same promise, one sentence.

PROPOSED

It is hard to see your own business clearly from the inside. These short checks ask a few honest questions and show you where to look first, with no jargon and no generic advice.

CHANGE FACT

NOW

Commercial Gaps Review: "Usually 8–15 questions, around 10 minutes."

PROPOSED

Usually 11 or 12 questions, around 10 minutes.

Why: The code asks 11 or 12 questions. It is also the only en dash left on the live site.

CHANGE COMMERCIAL

NOW

Commercial Gaps Review: "This is not an online consultancy service and it will not solve the business for you. It is here to help you and us both see the issue worth investigating..."

PROPOSED

It is a starting point: it helps you and us see the issue worth talking about, clearly enough to have a useful conversation.

Why: You told me on 6 October that we lead with what people get, not what we will not do. Same meaning, said positively.

CHANGE BRAND RULE

NOW

"free-text" (Owner Check and Commercial Gaps Review) and "day-to-day load" (Owner Check)

PROPOSED

"written answers in your own words" and "day to day"

Why: Hyphens, per your 30 September ruling. The quiz already says "day to day".

YOUR CALL STYLE

NOW

Product Guide: "This is not a diagnostic and it does not replace Tom looking properly at the business."

PROPOSED

It gives you a sensible next step. It does not replace Tom looking at the business properly.

Why: Leads with what it does. A light touch; the honesty of the second half is worth keeping.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- Owner Dependency Quiz intro, the 69% evidence paragraph and the source line, all approved by you.
- Market Ready Test intro: "There are no perfect businesses and there are no perfect answers." Keep.
- "Some owners simply want clarity. Others decide they'd like another pair of experienced eyes." Keep.

11 Useful Thinking (index page)

/useful-thinking

The articles are your own first-person writing and are left exactly as you approved them (see section 1). Only the index page is ours.

CHANGE FACT

NOW

"If any of this sounds familiar / One straightforward question is usually enough to work out whether a commercial review would help." with the button "Take the Owner Dependency Quiz"

PROPOSED

"If any of this sounds familiar / Eight quick questions will show you how much still runs through you." with the same button

Why: The line promises one question and the button opens an eight question quiz.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- "That gut feeling is not guesswork." Keep.
- The article summaries. They describe Tom in the third person, which is right for an index.

12 Pages reviewed and left alone

Read in full, nothing proposed, and why.

CHECKED AND KEPT

- Taxi and private hire operators: built and reviewed twice this week; your decisions of 7 October stand.
- Start-up idea review: frozen while the start-up Google Ads test runs, by your decision of 6 October. Anything here waits for the test to finish.
- Get your business ready to sell: approved by you on 25 to 27 September. One hyphen ("seven-figure") is in the hyphen list below.
- 30 Minute Conversation booking page and the thank-you page: short and plain. Only "Book a Time" should be "Book a time".
- Privacy: a legal statement, not voice copy.

13 What happens next

Nothing changes until you have been through this. Mark anything you disagree with, and tell me which way to go on the "Your call" items. Then I make the changes in one batch: CMS copy by guarded migration, so any edit you have made in the CMS is never overwritten, and code pages directly. After that I check every changed page on the live site and tell the Google Ads worker that the landing pages have moved.